extremist groups founded Hezbollah, apparently in the hope of establishing an Islamic State of Lebanon. Two years later, in 1987, Hamas, an offshoot of the Egyptian Muslim Brotherhood, was founded in Gaza City. Al-Qaeda, a radical Wahhabi movement calling for global jihad, was created in 1988–1989 by Osama bin Laden and Abdullah Yusuf Azzam. In Algeria, the Islamic Salvation Front started its bloody activities in 1989. Afghanistan became an Islamic State in 1992. The Taliban established the Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan in 1996. Countless more violent and deadly developments have taken place since. Radical Islam is now present on every continent. It has many names, various manifestations, and is now a global threat.

In the meantime, in a modern era when nationalism has been on the rise all over the world and the idea of national liberation filled the air, Zionism also emerged as the national liberation movement of the Jewish people. It urged Jews scattered all over the globe to return to the "Land of Israel." The movement began in the late nineteenth century when the Muslim world was losing its coherence. The First Aliyah [lit. "going up"] to Israel happened in 1881; the First Congress of the World Zionist Organization took place in Basel in 1897, and the Second Aliyah began in 1904.[10]

In the 1920s, as the Ottoman Empire was dismantled, and the secret societies, nationalist organizations, and fundamentalist movements arose in the Muslim world, Zionism also gained strength. In 1917, the Jewish Legion, a group of Zionist volunteers, assisted the British Army in Palestine (the name given to the land by Roman Emperor Hadrian in 135 A.D. to try to erase its Jewish roots). That year, the Balfour Declaration confirmed the support of the British government for "the establishment in Palestine of a national home for the Jewish people." In 1922, the League of Nations granted Britain a mandate over Palestine to do just that. The official document explicitly states that "a recognition has been given to the historical connection of the Jewish people with Palestine."[11]

Zionism was able to coexist with moderate Muslim kingdoms such as Morocco, with secular republics such as modern Turkey, and with partly Christian states such as Lebanon before its civil war. Islamic fundamentalism and Arab nationalism, however, were *not* compatible with Zionism. In the eyes of Islamic fundamentalists, Jews are *ahl al-dimmah*, people of the *dimmah*—inferiors who are allowed to survive in an Islamic-conquered land only if they accept being subjugated and deprived of legal equality or human rights.

Furthermore, in fundamentalist Islam, the entire world is divided into either the *Dar al-Islam* [House of Islam] or the *Dar al-Harb* [House of War, where Islam does not yet dominate]. In the eyes of Islamic fundamentalists,

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